

**EXAM HINTS****Computer-Based OET Speaking**

Official specifications from OET.com · July 2025

HINT 1 — Where the Exam Takes Place

In the computer-based OET (OET@Home®), the **Speaking sub-test is ALWAYS taken at home** — not at a test centre.

This means:

- ✓ You sit the exam in your own home, at your own desk.
- ✓ An interlocutor joins you remotely via the OET Speaking Platform (or Zoom for older bookings).
- ✓ Two role-plays, each 5 minutes long. Total test time: approximately 20–30 minutes.
- ⚠ The interlocutor **does not assess you** — a separate assessor listens to the recording.

HINT 2 — Highlighting the Role-Play Card**Computer-Based Exam (OET@Home)**

- ✗ You **CANNOT highlight the role-play card on screen**. The cards are displayed digitally and highlighting is not available.
- ✓ You **CAN bring one blank piece of paper** and a pen or pencil into the exam.
- ✓ Use the paper to **take notes, jot down key points, or plan your role-play** while reading the card.
- !! **At the end of the exam:** you must **tear/cut the paper in front of the camera** to confirm no information has been removed from the test environment.

Note: you may also pre-write your **confirmation number only** on this paper before the exam begins.

Paper-Based Exam

- ✓ Candidates **CAN highlight and underline** directly on the printed role-play card using a pencil — no restrictions.
- ✓ Use your pencil freely to mark the key task, patient details, and important information on the card.

HINT 3 — Official System & Environment Requirements

Source: OET Speaking Platform User Guide, July 2025 (oet.com)

**DEVICE & HARDWARE****INTERNET & NETWORK**

- ▶ **Device:** Laptop, desktop, or tablet (personal only — company-issued NOT allowed)

- ▶ **Minimum speed:** 5 Mbps upload AND download

▶ CPU: Min Intel i3 8th Gen / AMD Ryzen 3 — Rec. Intel i5 10th Gen+ ▶ RAM: Minimum 8 GB — Recommended 16 GB ▶ Camera: Adjustable webcam (min 480p, recommended 720p+). Bluetooth webcam NOT allowed ▶ Microphone & Speakers: Built-in or USB plug-in only. Bluetooth NOT allowed. No headsets/earphones during Speaking ▶ Monitors: Single monitor only. Dual monitors are NOT allowed ▶ Power: Device must be plugged directly into power source. No docking station. No battery only ▶ OS: Windows 10/11 (64-bit), macOS 10.15+, or Ubuntu 20.04 LTS ▶ Browser: Latest Chrome, Firefox, or Safari (macOS) ▶ VPN / Virtual Machine: Must be disabled before the exam	▶ Recommended speed: 20 Mbps upload and download for HD video ▶ Latency: Less than 50 ms for smooth audio/video ▶ Connection: Wired Ethernet/LAN preferred. Wi-Fi: use 5 GHz band, position device for strongest signal ▶ Limit other devices in the home from using the internet during your test  ROOM & ENVIRONMENT ▶ Indoors, well-lit, fully enclosed with solid walls (no glass/transparent panels) ▶ You must be completely alone — if anyone enters the room, the test is stopped ▶ Clean, clutter-free desk. Computer must be on a table/desk (not on a lap or bed) ▶ All extra screens (TV, second monitor) must be unplugged from the room ▶ No mobile phones, bags, watches, dictionaries, or reference materials ▶ Mirror required: bring a medium/large mirror (~30 cm × 30 cm) for the 360° environment check
--	---

✓ BRING TO THE EXAM	✗ DO NOT BRING
✓ Original, valid, unexpired government-issued ID ✓ Your laptop/desktop/tablet with webcam ✓ Clear plastic water bottle — no label, no lid ✓ One blank piece of paper + a regular pen or pencil (for notes during exam; must be destroyed in front of camera afterwards) ✓ A medium/large mirror (~30 cm × 30 cm) for the room check	✗ Mobile phone ✗ Headset, earphones, or headphones of any type ✗ Bags or pencil cases ✗ Watch or smart device ✗ Mechanical pencils or highlighters ✗ Dictionaries or reference materials ✗ Heavy coats or jackets ✗ Correction fluid or tape

 Dr. Ahmed's Tip: The paper note is your most important tool in the computer-based Speaking exam. Use it exactly as you would use a pencil to mark a printed card. Circle the task, write the patient's key details, jot your opening line — then destroy it at the end. Practise this habit from day one of your preparation.
